

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (indicated by two sharps), and 3/4 time. The melody consists of quarter and half notes, with some phrases spanning across bar lines. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: E, F#m, B, E, E, A, Bsus, B, E, A, F#m, G#, E/G#, G#m, F#m, B, and E. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, with three verses of text aligned under the notes. The first system contains the first line of each verse, the second system the second line, and the third system the third line. The lyrics are: Verse 1: 'Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,'; Verse 2: 'Now of my three - score years and ten,'; Verse 3: 'And since to look at things in bloom'; Verse 1: 'hung with bloom a - long the bough,'; Verse 2: 'twen - ty will not come a - gain.'; Verse 3: 'fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,'; Verse 1: 'it stands a - bout the wood - land ride'; Verse 2: 'And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,'; Verse 3: 'a - bout the wood - lands I will go,'; Verse 1: 'wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.'; Verse 2: 'leav - ing me just fif - ty more.'; Verse 3: 'see the cher - ry hung with snow.'

E F#m B E

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

E A Bsus B E

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
twen - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

A F#m G#

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

E/G# G#m F#m B E

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.